BPP Coursework Cover Sheet

Please use the table below as your cover sheet for the 1st page of the submission. The sheet should be before the cover/title page of your submission.

Programme	
Module name	
Student Reference Number (SRN)	
Report/Assignment Title	
Date of Submission *(Please attach the confirmation of any extension received)*	

Declaration of Original Work:

- I hereby declare that I have read and understood BPP's regulations on plagiarism and that this is my original work, and that I have researched, undertaken, completed and submitted in accordance with the requirements of BPP School of Business.

- I declare that where I have used any AI tools, it was for the following reasons (highlight as appropriate):
  - To review a draft
  - To correct language errors
  - Other (please describe)

    _____

- I have copied & retained for BPP University's reference, all AI prompts used in the creation of AI content and all AI-generated responses in support of my assignment and attached relevant evidence in the appendices.

- I understand that I may be required to participate in a *viva voce,* where I will be questioned on any aspect of my assignment, including key concepts, theories, examples used, & any sources included.

- The word count, excluding contents table, bibliography and appendices, is ___ words.

Student Reference Number: **Date**:

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By submitting this coursework you agree to all rules and regulations of BPP regarding assessments and awards for programmes. **Please note, submission is your declaration you are fit to sit.**

BPP University reserves the right to use all submitted work for educational purposes and may request that work be published for a wider audience.

BPP School of Business

BPP UNIVERSITY BUSINESS SCHOOL

BSc Applied Management

Global Business Fundamentals CW6

Coursework Assessment Brief

1. General Assessment Guidance

- Your summative assessment for this module is made up of this submission which accounts for **100**% of the marks
- **Please note late submissions will not be marked**.
- You are required to submit all elements of your assessment via **Turnitin online access**. Only submissions made via the specified mode will be accepted and hard copies or any other digital form of submissions (like via email or pen drive etc.) **will not be accepted**.
- For coursework, the submission word limit is **3500** words. You must comply with the word count guidelines. You may submit LESS than **3500** words but not more. Word Count guidelines can be found on your programme home page and the coursework submission page.
- **Do not put your name or contact details anywhere on your submission**. You should only put your student registration number (SRN) which will ensure your submission is recognised in the marking process.
- A total of 100 marks are available for this module assessment, and you are required to achieve minimum **40%** to **pass** this module.
- You are required to use only Harvard Referencing System in your submission. Any content which is already published by other author(s) and is not referenced will be considered as a case of plagiarism.
  You can find further information on Harvard Referencing in the online library on the Hub. You can use the following link to access this information: https://bpp.libguides.com/home/business
- BPP University has a strict policy regarding authenticity of assessments. In proven instances of plagiarism or collusion, severe punishment will be imposed on offenders. You are advised to read the rules and regulations regarding plagiarism and collusion in the GARs and UPPs which are available on the HUB in the Help and Support section under Documents and Forms.
- **Use of AI in assessments is only allowed for the purposes of reviewing a draft, correcting language errors or if specified in the summative assessment brief.** If you have used AI for any of these purposes, you should indicate this on the Assignment Cover sheet. For more information regarding acceptable and unacceptable use of AI, please enrol onto the Generative AI Foundations course on the HUB.
- You should include a completed copy of the **Assignment Cover sheet**. Any submission without this completed Assignment Cover sheet may be considered invalid and not marked.

2. Assessment Brief

To achieve a pass (40%) for this module you need to demonstrate that you have achieved the following module **Learning Outcomes**:

1. Explain the different types of organisations and business structures, including their purposes and implications. **(LO1)**
2. Understand the principles of market mechanisms, including demand, supply, and elasticity, and their significance for business strategy. **(LO2)**
3. Evaluate the impact of the external and internal environment on business organisations and their strategies. **(LO3)**
4. Assess the significance of the global factors on business organisations. **(LO4)**

For this assignment, you are a management consultant undertaking a series of projects for the board of Unilever plc.

Company Background: Unilever plc.

Unilever is a British-Dutch multinational corporation known for its extensive portfolio of consumer goods across the food, beverage, cleaning, and personal care industries. Founded in 1930 through the merger of the British soap maker Lever Brothers and the Dutch margarine producer Margarine Unie, Unilever has evolved into one of the world's largest and most recognizable fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) companies. Its headquarters are located in London, United Kingdom, and Rotterdam, Netherlands, reflecting its dual Anglo-Dutch heritage, although the company has been legally unified under a single British entity since 2020. Unilever shares are quoted on both the London Stock Exchange and Euronext Amsterdam. Additionally, Unilever shares are traded as American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) on the New York Stock Exchange.

The company's product offerings span a wide array of sectors, including nutrition, hygiene, and beauty. Its brands—such as Dove, Knorr, Lipton, Hellmann's, Axe, and Surf—are household names in over 190 countries. Unilever employs a decentralized brand strategy, allowing it to respond effectively to local consumer preferences while maintaining global scale and supply chain efficiency. This adaptability, combined with substantial investment in marketing and research and development, has helped Unilever maintain a competitive advantage in highly saturated global markets.

Unilever is widely recognized for its strong commitment to sustainability and corporate social responsibility. The Unilever Sustainable Living Plan, launched in 2010, set ambitious targets to reduce the company's environmental footprint and improve social outcomes across its value chain. These initiatives include cutting greenhouse gas emissions, reducing plastic waste, enhancing water stewardship, and promoting human rights. Unilever has positioned sustainability as a core business strategy rather than a peripheral concern, believing that long-term commercial success is inextricably linked to social and environmental well-being.

In addition to its sustainability initiatives, Unilever has also played a significant role in advancing diversity, equity, and inclusion within its workforce and marketing strategies. The company emphasizes gender equality, fair representation, and inclusive growth. Its leadership in environmental, social, and governance (ESG) metrics has made it a frequent subject of case studies and rankings by ethical investment funds. However, Unilever has also faced criticism and scrutiny,

particularly around issues such as supply chain labour practices and the use of palm oil, which have challenged the company's ethical positioning.

Unilever represents a model of a diversified, global enterprise with deep commitments to innovation, sustainability, and responsible business practices. Its ability to navigate complex international markets while advancing progressive values has made it a leading force in the FMCG sector. As consumer preferences continue to evolve in favour of ethical consumption and environmental stewardship, Unilever's strategic focus on sustainability and brand authenticity positions it well for future growth and influence in the global economy.

Further information can be found at the following website:

https://www.unilever.com/our-company/

It is recommended that you carry out a substantial amount of independent and individual research to strengthen your understanding of the external and internal factors that shape business environments, the role of market mechanisms, and the impact of globalisation on business organisations.

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Assessment Tasks

Acting as a management consultant undertaking a series of projects for the Board of Unilever plc. ("**Unilever**") you are required to **write a strategic repor**t (3,500 words) that aligns Unilever's global operations and strategies with the principles of market mechanisms, organisational structures, and the impact of globalisation. **Please note that your submission must be in Word format and PowerPoint submissions will not be accepted.**

The report must address the following **four** tasks:

Task 1: Discuss Organisational Structures and Business Purposes (LO1) *Suggested word allocation: 875 words)*
Guideline:

- Research and explain Unilever's organisational structure and business purposes.
- Identify and discuss their impact on efficiency and innovation.
- Give examples and comparisons with either other global consumer goods companies or consumer goods companies from your own domestic region.
- Explain the different business structures found in the consumer goods industry.

Task 2: Evaluate the impact of Internal and External Environments on Business Strategy (LO3) (*Suggested word allocation: 875 words)*

Guideline:

- Evaluate Unilever's internal factors (i.e. leadership, corporate culture and resources).
- Identify and evaluate external influences (i.e. political regulations and economic conditions, conduct PESTLE analysis)
- Explain Unilever's competitive environment (i.e. using Porter's Five Forces) and discuss strategic changes in response to key risks (e.g., COVID-19 recovery) and opportunities.

Task 3: Discuss Market Mechanisms and Business Strategy (LO2) - (*Suggested word allocation: 875 words)*
Guideline:

- Provide an explanation of how **demand**, **supply** and **elasticity** affect Unilever's business operations and pricing.
- Evaluate how government interventions impact on market position (i.e. regulation, tariff, taxes).
- Analyse how market mechanisms can enhance Unilever's competitiveness and financial performance.

Task 4: Assess the Global Factors of Business Organisations (LO4) (*Suggested word allocation: 875 words)*

Guideline:

- Analyse how globalisation, trade agreements, tariffs affect Unilever

- Identify how corporate social responsibility (CSR) and climate policies influence Unilever's strategic decisions.
- Explain the effects of international regulations and competition on Unilever's operations and strategic choices.

Note:
All findings must be supported by relevant and appropriate academic literature and commercial research / evidence.

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Report Structure

BPP Cover Sheet
Report Title Sheet
Table of Contents
Introduction (Suggested word allocation: 250 words)
Organisational Structures and Business Purposes (LO1)
Impact of Internal and External Environment on Business Strategy (LO3)
Market Mechanisms and Business Strategy (LO2)
Global Factors and Business Organisations (LO4)
Conclusion (Suggested word allocation: 250 words)

- **Appendices:** Appendices contain additional information that is too detailed to include in the main body. Typical examples of information included in appendices can be glossaries (if it is a technical report), tables with supporting statistical data, examples of research, and so on.

- **References list:** If you have consulted any source, either printed or online, you ***must*** include it in an alphabetical list of your references presented in Harvard style –with dates of internet access, where applicable.

Word count: 3500 words. The word count only applies to the main body (**shown in bold**); i.e., cover page, table of contents, introduction, conclusion, references and appendix are **not** part of the 3500-word count.

If you have any further questions about this coursework assignment, please contact the module leader or your tutor.

Academic Skills and Referencing

- Structure is in line with the given instructions.
- Report has a professional appearance with consistent formatting.
- Spelling and grammar are correct.
- Each page has a page number in the Footer.
- Any tables or figures are correctly labelled and include Harvard style citation.
- Tables and figures do not cross page boundaries, unless necessary.
- Properly cite your sources in the text and in the list of references.
- Use Harvard style for referencing and in-text citations (see referencing guides and https://bpp.libguides.com/Home/StudySupport)

3. Marking Guide

Criterion		0-29% Fail	30-39% Marginal Fail	40-49% Pass	50-59% Lower second	60-69% Upper second	70-79% First	80-100% First
LO1:	**Organisational Structures and Business Purposes**	Shows a **lack of understanding** of the company's organisational structure and its implications. The discussion is **superficial, with minimal reference** to strategic objectives, global business environment, or examples. There **is little to no critical evaluation** or specific examples, and the analysis is **poorly structured** and unsupported by evidence.	Shows a **limited understanding** of the topic. The discussion touches on the company's organisational structure, strategic objectives, and global business environment but lacks **depth and clarity.** The **critical evaluation is weak**, with few specific examples and **limited analysis**. The overall argument is not **well-developed** and lacks coherence.	Shows a **satisfactory understanding** of the company's organisational structure and its implications. The discussion covers strategic objectives and the global business environment with **some clarity**. The critical evaluation is present but **may lack depth and critical insight**. Specific examples are used but **may not be fully developed or integrated**.	Shows a **good understanding** of the company's organisational structure and its implications. The discussion **is clear and well-structured**, covering the company's organisational structure, strategic objectives, and global business environment in detail. The **critical evaluation is coherent** and demonstrates insight, supported by specific examples. The argument is **generally strong**, though **some areas** may need **further development**.	Shows a **very good understanding** of the company's organisational structure and its implications. The discussion is **thorough and well-structured**, providing a **detailed analysis of strategic objectives** and the global business environment. The critical evaluation is **strong, with well-chosen examples and a high level of insight**. The argument is **coherent and demonstrates critical thinking.**	Shows an **excellent understanding** of the company's organisational structure and its implications. The discussion is **comprehensive and exceptionally well-structured**, offering an **in-depth analysis** of the company's organisational structure, strategic objectives, and the global business environment. The critical evaluation is **highly insightful**, supported by expertly chosen examples. The argument is **exceptionally coherent**, **demonstrating exceptional critical thinking** and **suggesting meaningful areas** for improvement**.**	Demonstrates an **outstanding** understanding of the company's organisational structure and its implications. The discussion provides a **detailed** and **deeply integrated discussion** of the company's organisational structure, strategic goals, and the global business landscape. **Exceptional** critical evaluation is evident, bolstered by highly relevant and meticulously selected examples. The argument is **exceedingly** coherent, showcasing **outstanding critical thinking** and **proposing innovative** suggestions for enhancement.
LO2:	**Market Mechanisms and Business Strategy**	Shows an **inadequate understanding** of how market mechanisms affect the company's operations. There is **little** to **no analysis** of demand and supply, elasticity, government	Shows **limited knowledge** and **limited understanding** of the task. The explanation of how demand and supply affect the company's operations is **meaningless.**	Shows a **Satisfactory** understanding that addresses the basic requirements of the task. There is a **general explanation** of how demand and supply affect the company's operations, with **some**	Shows a **good understanding** that covers all aspects of the task. **Good** and **reasonable explanation** of demand and supply effects on the company's operations.	Shows a **very good** understanding that covers all aspects of the task. Demonstrating a **thorough understanding** of how demand and supply influence the company's operations.	Shows an **excellent understanding** that covers all aspects of the task. Provides a **comprehensive** and insightful **analysis** of demand and supply	Shows an **outstanding understanding** that covers all aspects of the task. Provides an **outstanding comprehensive** and outstanding analysis on how demand and supply

		interventions, or market mechanisms. The work **lacks coherence, detail**, and evidence, failing to meet the basic requirements of the task**.**	The role of elasticity in pricing strategies **is barely touched** upon and **not well supported** by evidence. Government interventions and the application of market mechanisms **lack depth and critical insight**.	**mention** of demand fluctuations and partnerships. Elasticity in pricing strategies is **discussed briefly**. Government interventions are noted, and there is an **adequate analysis** of market mechanisms, though the **insights remain general.**	The role of elasticity in pricing strategies is **covered** with **some relevant examples**. Government interventions are **evaluated** with **a fair level of detail**, and the **analysis** of market mechanisms shows **a good understanding**, though it could benefit from **more critical insights and evidence**.	There is a **detailed discussion** on elasticity in pricing strategies, supported by **relevant examples**. Government interventions are **evaluated critically**, and the analysis of market mechanisms is **comprehensive and well-supported by evidence.**	effects on the company's operations. The discussion on elasticity in pricing strategies is **detailed** and **well-integrated**. Government interventions are **evaluated with exceptional depth**, and the application of market mechanisms is **examined with robust evidence**, demonstrating a **high level** of **understanding and critical insight.**	affect the company's business operations. The discussion on elasticity in pricing strategies is outstanding with **detail** and **well-integrated** The evaluation of government interventions and the role of market mechanisms in improving the company's competitiveness and financial success displays a **high level** of **critical insight** and **originality**.
LO3:	**Impact of Internal and External Environments on Business Strategy**	Shows an **inadequate understanding** of the task requirements, with significant gaps in identifying key internal factors, conducting a PESTLE analysis, using Porter's Five Forces, and discussing the company's strategic adaptations. The work **lacks coherence, critical analysis, and depth**, failing to meet the basic academic standards.	Shows **limited knowledge** and understanding of the task. The identification of internal factors and external analysis using PESTLE and Porter's Five Forces is **insignificant,** with **minimal references** and **poor analytical depth**. The discussion on the company's adaptation strategies **lacks critical insight** and is **not well-supported** by evidence.	Shows a **satisfactory** understanding of addressing the basic requirements of the task. Key internal factors are **identified**, and a PESTLE analysis is conducted, though but with **limited critical analysis**. Porter's Five Forces are used appropriately, but the **insights remain general**. The company's strategic adaptations are **discussed adequately** but **lack depth** and	Shows a **good understanding** that covers all aspects of the task. Internal factors and the PESTLE analysis are identified with **reasonable detail** and are supported by relevant examples. The use of Porter's Five Forces demonstrates a **good understanding**, with **some critical** insights. The company's strategic adaptations are	Shows a **very good** and **thorough** understanding of the internal and external factors affecting the company. The PESTLE analysis and Porter's Five Forces are conducted with a **high level of detail** and critical analysis. The discussion on the company's strategies is **comprehensive, well-supported** by evidence, and **demonstrates clear insight** into the impact of these strategies.	Shows an **excellent understanding** providing a **comprehensive** and **insightful analysis** of internal and external factors influencing the company. The PESTLE analysis and Porter's Five Forces are **detailed, critical**, and **well-integrated** into the discussion. The strategies of the company are examined with **exceptional depth**, supported **by robust evidence**, and demonstrates a high level of understanding.	Shows an **outstanding understanding** of the task. Provides a **detailed discussion** of the company's organisational structure, strategic goals, and global business landscape. **Exceptional critical evaluation**, covering internal forces such as leadership and resources, and external forces like economic conditions and regulation.

				comprehensive evidence.	discussed **well**, showing an understanding of risk mitigation and opportunity leverage.			PESTLE analysis and Porter's Five Forces are expertly **integrated**. Proposes **innovative enhancements.**
LO4:	**Global Factors and Business Organisations**	Shows **inadequate** or **very little understanding** of the impact of globalisation on the company. The evaluation of international trade agreements, tariffs, and regulatory frameworks is **largely missing** or **irrelevant**. CSR and sustainability initiatives are **not discussed**, and there is **no examination** of global factors affecting the company's strategic decisions.	Shows a **limited** and basic understanding of the task. The analysis of the impact of globalisation on the company is **vague** and **lacks depth**. The evaluation of international trade agreements, tariffs, and regulatory frameworks is **underdeveloped.** Contributions on CSR, sustainability initiatives, and the influence of global factors like climate change policies are **minima**l and **lack critical insight**.	Shows **satisfactory** understanding of the task. The evaluation of international trade agreements, tariffs, and regulatory frameworks is **present but lacks depth**. CSR and sustainability initiatives are mentioned, and there is **an adequate discussion** on global factors influencing the company's strategic decisions, though **insights remain general**.	Shows a **good** understanding of the task P The evaluation of international trade agreements, tariffs, and regulatory frameworks is **fair** and includes some **relevant details**. CSR and sustainability initiatives are discussed with **a good level** of understanding, and the analysis of global factors such as climate change policies shows a **good grasp of the subject**, though it could benefit from **more critical insights and evidence**.	Show a **very good** understanding of the task. Demonstrates a **thorough understanding** of globalisation's effects on the company. The evaluation of international trade agreements, tariffs, and regulatory frameworks is **comprehensive and well-supported by evidence**. CSR and sustainability initiatives are **evaluated critically**, and the discussion on global factors influencing the company's strategic decisions is **well-rounded and insightful**.	Shows an **excellent** understanding of the task. Provides a **comprehensive** and **insightful analysis** of the impact of globalisation on the company. The evaluation of international trade agreements, tariffs, and regulatory frameworks is **exceptionally thorough** and supported by **robust evidence.** CSR and sustainability initiatives are **examined with depth**, and the analysis of global factors affecting the company's strategic decisions demonstrates a **high level of understanding and critical insight.**	Demonstrates an **outstanding** understanding of the task. Provides an **exceptionally thorough** and **perceptive analysis** of the impact of globalisation on the company. The evaluation of international trade agreements, tariffs, and regulatory frameworks is **extraordinarily detailed**, supported by **robust** and **compelling** evidence. CSR and sustainability initiatives are **examined** with **remarkable depth**, and the analysis of global factors affecting the organisation's strategic decisions reflects an **exceptional level** of critical insight and originality.
Cognitive Skills	Academic skills	***Inadequate*** *academic/intellectual skills and repeatedly fails with structure/expression.*	***Limited*** *academic/intellectual skills and major difficulty with structure/expression. Wholly imitative and descriptive. Limited practical/professional skills*	***Satisfactory*** *academic/intellectual skills. Still mainly imitative and descriptive.*	***Good*** *academic/ intellectual skills with some difficulties. Largely imitative and descriptive. Some difficulty with structure and accuracy in expression, but developing practical/professional skills*	***Very good*** *academic/intellectual skills with few difficulties. Largely original work with some evidence of reflection and critique. Structure and accuracy in expression beginning to emerge.*	***Excellent*** *academic/intellectual skills. Original work with personal reflection and broad evidence-based critique. Solid structure and accuracy in expression. Practical/professional skills evident.*	***Outstanding*** *academic/intellectual skills. Wholly original work with good reflection and solid, well-reasoned judgements forming from evidence-based critique. Consistent structure and accuracy in expression. Practical/professional skills established.*

	Referencing	***Inadequate*** *or nil referencing with numerous errors and omissions.*	***Very limited*** *referencing with numerous errors and omissions*	***Satisfactory*** *references and notes with inconsistencies, errors or omissions*	***Good*** *references and notes but may contain inconsistencies, errors or omissions*	***Very good*** *references and notes with minor or insignificant errors or omissions*	***Excellent*** *with full and appropriate references and notes with minor or insignificant errors.*	***Outstanding*** *with precise, full and appropriate references and notes.*